

Assistive Devices for Arthritis – UK Buyer's Guide

Complete UK guide to assistive devices for arthritis. From jar openers to mobility aids, discover what's available free through the NHS and what to buy.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-02-04 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

The right assistive devices can transform daily life with arthritis, making tasks easier and reducing joint strain. Many items are available free through the NHS or your local council, while others can be purchased affordably from UK retailers.

Kitchen Aids

- Electric tin opener — eliminates hand twisting (from £10)
 - Jar opener (under-cabinet) — grips the lid so you only need to turn the jar (from £5)
 - Kettle tipper — cradle for your kettle that pours without lifting (from £15)
 - Ergonomic utensils — thick, soft-grip handles for knives, peelers, and spoons (from £8)
 - One-handed chopping board — with spikes and corner grip to hold food steady (from £20)
 - Perching stool — sit while working at kitchen counters (from £30, or free via OT)
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Bathroom Aids



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- Grab rails — for bath, shower, and toilet (from £10, often fitted free by council)
- Shower seat/stool — sit safely while showering (from £20, or free via OT)
- Raised toilet seat — reduces the distance you need to bend (from £15)
- Long-handled sponge — reach your back and feet without bending (from £5)
- Lever taps — easier to turn than round taps (tap turners from £3)

Dressing Aids

- Long-handled shoe horn — put on shoes without bending (from £3)
- Button hook — fasten buttons one-handed (from £5)

- Elastic shoelaces — turn lace-ups into slip-ons (from £4)
 - Sock aid — put on socks without bending down (from £5)
 - Zip puller — large loop to grip zip pulls easily (from £3)
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Mobility Aids



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- Walking stick — reduces load on hip and knee by up to 25% (from £10)
- Walking frame/rollator — four-wheeled with seat for resting (from £50)
- Ergonomic crutches — forearm crutches with soft grips (from £30)
- Wheelchair — for longer distances; available through NHS wheelchair services

Where to Get Free Equipment

- NHS occupational therapy — ask your GP for an OT referral for home assessment and free equipment
 - Local council — contact adult social care for a community OT assessment
 - Disabled Facilities Grant — up to £30,000 (England) for major home adaptations like stairlifts and wet rooms
 - British Red Cross — short-term loan of wheelchairs and mobility aids
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Where to Buy in the UK



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- Ability Superstore — comprehensive online shop for disability aids
- NRS Healthcare — wide range with next-day delivery
- Amazon UK — search "arthritis aids" for extensive range
- Argos — mobility aids and bathroom equipment
- Local mobility shops — try equipment before buying

Don't struggle in silence — simple aids can make a huge difference. Start with a free OT assessment to find out what's available to you.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about assistive devices for arthritis – uk buyer's guide?

Short answer: Assistive devices can help manage arthritis by making daily tasks easier and reducing joint strain. Examples include kitchen aids like electric tin openers, kettle tippers, and ergonomic utensils. For the bathroom, grab rails, shower seats, and raised toilet seats are available. Dressing aids such as long-handled shoe horns and sock aids can assist, while mobility aids like walking sticks and wheelchairs can improve movement.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Versus Arthritis: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk